

Gopal Kumar

gopal.kumar@berkeley.edu | www.linkedin.com/in/gkciitp | (510) 944 – 9097 | Berkeley, CA, 94703 | [Lets Chat!](#)

EDUCATION

University of California, Berkeley

August 2022 - May 2023

Master of Engineering, Industrial Engineering & Operations Research (FinTech)

Relevant Coursework: optimization analytics; risk modeling, simulation & data analysis; applications of machine learning to electronic markets; introduction to financial engineering; financial engineering systems I

Indian Institute of Technology, Patna

July 2014 - May 2018

Bachelor of Technology, Computer Science & Engineering

Relevant Coursework: intro to computing; data structures & algorithms; probability theory; software engineering; databases

TECHNICAL STACK

Languages: Python, R, VBA, AHK, Auto IT, AMPL

Web: Bootstrap, HTML5, JavaScript/jQuery, CSS, Django, Selenium

Databases: MySQL, Oracle

Libraries: pandas, numpy, matplotlib, seaborn, scikit-learn, statsmodels

Tools: Excel, EViews, Tableau, Haver Analytics, JPM DataQuery, Refinitiv, Bloomberg, JIRA, Git, AWS, CPLEX, Snowflake

Interests: operations research, operations management, program management, data science, analytics, automation, alternative data.

WORK EXPERIENCE

JP Morgan

Mumbai, India

Associate, Economic & Policy Research, US Economics, Corporate & Investment Banking

Jan 2020 – May 2022

- Supported senior analysts with tasks such as data cleaning, wrangling, modeling, quantitative forecasting, and creating informative charts and visualizations. Developed, implemented, and documented the data strategy for the team.
- Coauthored **20+ research notes** commenting on data releases and economic policies. Averaged weekly views of 1000+ clients.
- Authored articles for top media publications like **Bloomberg Quint** and **Yahoo Finance** under the banner of JP Morgan.
- Secured **3rd place** in DataViz competition on Foursquare data across Corporate & Investment Banking, JP Morgan.
- Member of the Global Fixed-Income research team, which topped rankings by institutional investors in 2020 and 2021.

Analyst, Automation & process optimization, Global Research, Corporate & Investment Banking

Jul 2018 – Dec 2019

- Planned, designed, and executed innovative automation & analytic projects focused on periodic research report generation, web scraping, database setup, and building automation tools to support **1500+ analysts** in JP Morgan research.
- Collaborated to save approximately **4000+ man hours** per year by optimizing processes and enhancing efficiency based on inputs from analysts in JP Morgan research.
- Pioneered the team setup as the first full-time recruit, improved organizational structures between cross-functional teams, and enhanced communication with clients. Contributed to team expansion by participating in hiring processes.

KEY PROJECTS

- “**Optimizing Time Series Forecasts with Synthetic Data Generation**”, Jan-May 2023, UC Berkeley Capstone project. (Tech- Python)
 - Enhancing long-term returns in stock market through the application of data augmentation techniques in neural network optimization
- “**US: Alternative Data-Driven Jobs Tracker**”, with US Econ research team, 2020-21, JP Morgan. (Tech- Python: scikit-learn)
 - Reimagined the ‘payroll jobs tracking’ by utilizing high-frequency alternative data series (~25 series) to forecast jobs growth (nonfarm payroll).
- “**US: Chase Card Retail Sales Nowcasting**”, with US Econ research team, 2020-2021, JP Morgan.
 - Developed a nowcasting tracker for monthly retail sales using proprietary Chase card consumer spending data. (Tech- Python: scikit-learn)
- “**JP Morgan Research News Aggregator**”, with Research FinTech team, 2018-2019, JP Morgan. (Tech- Django, python, HTML, CSS, Js)
 - Designed, built, and deployed a news aggregator system for individual research analysts using RSS feeds, News API, web scrapers.

NOTABLE PUBLICATIONS

- “**India: A Powell-ian deconstruction of India’s CPI**”, with Sajjid Z Chinoy & Toshi Jain in Bloomberg Quint, Oct 2021, JP Morgan.
 - Directed the development of a product that assesses inflation trends in India, offering three alternative inflation estimates (‘diffusion index’, ‘trimmed mean index’ & ‘disproportionality index’) and insights into key CPI drivers (~300 time series), garnering 3k+ user engagements.
- “**US: Lessons from a year of alt data watching**”, with Jesse Edgerton & Dan Weitzenfeld, Mar 2021, JP Morgan.
 - Note summarizing utility of alternative data. Concluded high-frequency data provided early signals of dramatic turning points during the pandemic.
- “**Latent dirichlet allocation modeling for CPS patent topic discovery**”, with U.H.Govindarajan & Amy J.C. Trappey in IcoIESE, '18.
 - Implemented LDA model for topic modeling which identified relationships between terms and topics explaining underlying IP dynamics.

LEADERSHIP

- Affinity Group Leader, FinTech** – Fung Institute, University of California, Berkeley, (Aug 2022 –Present), Berkeley, CA: Connected with industry experts to explore, learn, and promote the dynamic field of FinTech.
- Secretary, House of Socio-Cultural Affair, Student Gymkhana** – IIT Patna, (July 2016 – May 2018), Patna, India: Headed events committee of the university which supervised the organization and management of all cultural events with a yearly budget ~\$25,000 USD.

AWARDS

- Awarded the **Fung Fellowship** at Fung Institute for Engineering leadership, UC Berkeley (2022), United States. (40,000 USD\$)
- Awarded National Tsing Hua University’s **GEL(Global Engineering Leadership) fellowship** for research (2017), Taiwan.(100,000 NT\$)